Phase 1: Brainstorming & Ideation

Purpose: Identify the operational problem and convert it into a focused automation idea.

Problem identified

The current IT procurement process has manual overhead and can cause delays in standard laptop requests, especially when configuration is required. The project document specifically identifies the risk of configuration oversight or delay and its effect on users and IT resource allocation.

User story

As a member of the IT procurement team, I want a streamlined process for ordering standard laptops so that tasks are automatically generated and assigned to the Hardware team for configuration. This is intended to ensure that laptops are configured promptly after arrival, reducing user wait time and manual intervention.

Proposed idea

- Use ServiceNow Service Catalog as the request entry point for the Standard Laptop item.
- Use Flow Designer to automate the creation of a Catalog Task after the request is approved.
- Populate the task with a clear configuration description.
- Automatically assign the task to the Hardware group.
- Verify the generated Catalog Task from the Requested Item record.

Expected value

- More consistent handling of standard laptop requests.
- Less manual task creation and assignment.
- Reduced chance of configuration work being overlooked.
- Better visibility of the configuration task in the Requested Item.
- More efficient use of the Hardware team’s time.

Ideation output

Selected concept: Automate standard laptop configuration task creation and Hardware assignment through ServiceNow Flow Designer after request approval.